

AMARNATH S. PATEL

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EDUCATION

University of Central Florida

Undergraduate Student 4.00 GPA

B.S. in Physics (Optics & Lasers) and Mathematics, Computer Science Minor (43 credit hours) August 2025 – Present

Florida Atlantic University

3.66 GPA

University coursework completed via FAU High School, ages 14–18 (108 credit hours; 3 more August 2021 – May 2025 at Palm Beach State College)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

UCF Astrophotonics Lab, CREOL — Undergraduate Researcher

August 2025 – Present

Supervisor: Dr. Stephen Eikenberry

- Measured the wavelength-dependent complex transfer matrix of a photonic lantern by [off-axis digital holography](#), extending Dobias et al., *Opt. Express* **34**(9), 17217 (2026). Aligned the interferometric bench and acquired holograms of the multimode output for each input port across the C-band (1525–1575 nm), recovering full amplitude and phase — one row of the transfer matrix per measurement.
- Implemented the phase-retrieval and mode-decomposition analysis: FFT sideband isolation and demodulation, Butterworth low-pass, joint numerical optimization of mode-field diameter, defocus quadratic phase and field position, then decomposition onto the LP basis to recover complex modal amplitude and phase.
- Produced the per-port reconstruction-fidelity characterization for 6- and 7-port lanterns, reaching $\approx 98\%$ fidelity $|\langle E_{\text{rec}}, E_{\text{sim}} \rangle|^2$ against simulated fields.
- Automated the four-instrument acquisition chain — tunable laser, InGaAs camera, fiber switch, and motorized polarization control — so a complete all-port $\times$ C-band sweep runs unattended, with polarization optimized in-loop for peak fringe contrast and saturated frames rejected, reducing a full dataset from days of manual bench time to a single hands-off run.
- Contribute mount control and pointing automation to [PolyOculus](#), an astronomical instrument program building photometric observing capability from a networked array of 8 telescopes.

UCF Physics Department — Undergraduate Research Assistant

March 2026 – Present

Physics Education Research — Dr. Zhongzhou Chen (NSF Award 2421299; Gates Foundation INV-076932)

- Research on automated assessment generation for introductory physics instruction: built [ESTELA](#), a system producing multi-version isomorphic exams from structured problem banks, and an agentic generation–evaluation pipeline that iteratively drafts and validates new problems against instructor criteria.
- Materials authored for the project are in use by external adopters following a faculty workshop. Manuscript in preparation.

FAU Grant-Funded AI Safety Research Project (High School)

January 2024 – March 2025

Supervisor: Tucker Hindle, Florida Atlantic University

- Benchmarked 10+ coherence and detection methods (GPT-2 perplexity, RoBERTa, BERT NSP, LSA, NLI, burstiness) across 3,125+ generated sequences; identified GPT-2 perplexity as the strongest discriminator ($3.3\times$ separation between coherent and incoherent text).
 - Characterized a consistent quality–evasion tradeoff across four adversarial humanization pipelines. Grant-funded with HPC access; presented at the Wilkes Honors College Symposium (2025).
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OTHER EXPERIENCE

Secretary — National Society of Black Physicists (NSBP), UCF Chapter

2025 – Present

- Coordinate meetings, records, and communications for the UCF student chapter of the National Society of Black Physicists.

President — Coding Club, Florida Atlantic University (High School)

2023 – 2025

- Founded and led a student coding club; organized meetings and collaborative programming projects with peers.

Teaching Assistant — Calculus (High School)

August 2024 – May 2025

- Assisted 70 undergraduate students with learning calculus; office hours, exam review, grading. Part-time (10 h/week).

Advanced Experimental Vehicles — Programmer, Leader, Builder (High School) November 2023 – May 2025

- Configured Arch Linux ARM on Raspberry Pi 5 with Hyprland compositor and WireGuard VPN, enabling worldwide real-time telemetry monitoring of BMS, GPS, and camera feeds.
- Won 2nd Place in Division and Lockheed Martin Award for “Highest Level of Engineering Excellence.”

PRESENTATIONS

Batch Processing for Automated Grading via Azure OpenAI

June 2026

University of Central Florida, Downtown Campus. ESTELA project (Physics Education Research, Dr. Zhongzhou Chen).

Coherence and Detection Approaches for Identifying AI-Generated Text

March 2025

Wilkes Honors College Undergraduate Research Symposium, Florida Atlantic University.

TECHNICAL REPORTS

Coherence and Detection Approaches for Identifying AI-Generated Text

2025

- Empirical study of AI-text detection and adversarial evasion: benchmarked 10 coherence and detection methods (GPT-2 perplexity best, $3.35\times$ separation; RoBERTa the only effective detector) and built four evasion pipelines, characterizing a consistent quality–evasion tradeoff. Grant-funded, Florida Atlantic University.

SELECTED PROJECTS

CELERIS — Metalens Design Pipeline & From-Scratch RCWA Solver

2026

- From-scratch solver for Maxwell’s equations in periodic subwavelength structures via rigorous coupled-wave analysis / the Fourier modal method: 1D TE/TM multilayer gratings with Li/Liu–Fan inverse-rule factorization, full 2D-vectorial $P \cdot Q$ formulation for biperiodic nanopillar arrays, and stable Redheffer scattering-matrix layer recursion.
- Validated every layer of the stack against closed-form physics, an independent method, or energy conservation: RCWA vs. transfer-matrix method to $1e-6$, multilayer S-matrix to $1e-15$, 2D→1D degenerate reduction to $5e-12$, Σ (diffraction efficiency) = 1.000000, and diffraction-limited designed focal spots at $\text{FWHM} = \lambda f / D$. Independently cross-validated against the grcwa and Stanford S^4 solvers ($\approx 1e-7$) and reproduces canonical published metalenses (Khorasaninejad et al., *Science* 2016; Chen et al., *Nat. Nanotechnol.* 2018).
- Implemented the physical design and analysis capability standalone RCWA kernels lack: Sellmeier and tabulated n, k dispersion, meta-atom library sweeps with automatic etch-depth selection for full- 2π phase coverage, gradient-based (Adam) inverse design, Pancharatnam–Berry geometric-phase and polarization-multiplexed lenses exploiting form birefringence (reporting per-polarization RMS phase and focal isolation in dB), plus Strehl, Zernike wavefront, MTF, chromatic focal shift, through-focus caustic, and fabrication-tolerance Monte-Carlo analysis with fabrication-ready GDSII export.
- Accelerated Rayleigh–Sommerfeld far-field propagation as a CUDA kernel, benchmarked against the project’s own optimized 16-core CPU path: $4.8\text{--}5.8\times$ at 92k pillars, agreeing to machine precision, with automatic CPU fallback. Diagnosed the kernel as memory-bound from the speedup’s decline with grid size. C++23/CUDA, with Python bindings and a native desktop GUI. *Sole-author manuscript in preparation (Computer Physics Communications).*

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Instrumentation: GPIB/VISA, RS-232, INDI, GigE Vision camera acquisition, tunable IR laser control, motorized polarization control, interferometric alignment, FITS & GDSII data formats

Scientific Computing: FFT & signal processing, phase retrieval & modal decomposition, electromagnetic simulation (RCWA), GPU/CUDA acceleration, NumPy, SciPy

Programming Languages: C/C++, CUDA, Python, Shell (Fish, Bash, tcsh), LaTeX/Typst

Tools: Linux, Git, CMake, Qt/PySide6

SELECTED COURSEWORK

Physics: Electricity & Magnetism I (in progress), Mathematical Methods for Physics, Modern Physics, Quantum Information Processing, Geometric Optics & Lab

Mathematics: Linear Algebra (proof-based, in progress), Partial Differential Equations (in progress), Complex Variables, Matrix & Linear Algebra, Statistical Methods

Computer Science: Deep Learning, Data Structures & Algorithm Analysis, Computer Architecture, Discrete Structures

HONORS & AWARDS

President’s Honor Roll, University of Central Florida (Fall 2025, Spring 2026)	2025 – 2026
Florida Bright Futures — Florida Academic Scholars (highest tier; 100% tuition)	2025
Lockheed Martin Award — “Highest Level of Engineering Excellence,” AEV Competition	2024
2nd Place in Division, Advanced Experimental Vehicles Competition	2024
1st Place, Night Hacks Hackathon — UniUtils (course schedule generator & classroom finder)	2023